

QUESTION-TO-SLIDE MAPPING

SECTION A - LECTURE 06

Contractors & Subcontractors

Course	BECM 3101 - Construction and Project Management I
Lecture deck	6.0 - Contractors (16 PDF pages)
Question bank	Term-final examinations, 2016-2024 (25 pages)
Method	Questions are mapped to the most relevant PDF slide/page, regardless of whether the original examination placed them in Section A or Section B.

RESULT

This is a consistently repeated and highly exam-relevant lecture. Every examination year from 2016 to 2024 contains at least one contractor/subcontractor question, with the strongest repetition in typical subcontracting characteristics, attendance and the domestic-nominated-named classification.

Prepared as part of the cumulative lecture-by-lecture question-bank analysis.

1. Executive Summary

The lecture defines the general contractor and subcontractor, explains the subcontract relationship, payment clauses, reasons for subcontracting, concerns, types of subcontractors and attendance. Slide numbers below use the PDF page count, with the title page counted as Slide 1.

16	13	6	6	1	138
Slides reviewed	Question links	Exact matches	Direct matches	Partial matches	Mapped marks

Classification	Meaning
Exact	The requested definition, classification or explanation is directly presented in the lecture.
Direct	The lecture contains the complete building blocks, but the student must combine several slides or organize them under the exam wording.
Partial	Only part of the requested answer appears; another class note or source is necessary.

Highest-priority slide blocks

Priority	Slides	Topic	Why it matters
1	15 + 5-6	Attendance + typical subcontracting characteristics	Repeated in 2018, 2021, 2022, 2023 and expanded again in 2024.
2	10-14	Domestic, nominated and named subcontractors	Appears in 2019, 2020, 2021, 2023 and 2024; usually a 9-13 mark question.
3	3-4 + 8	Contractor/subcontractor definitions and why subcontract	The exact 2016 long question and the reason component of 2019/2021.
4	5-7	Subcontract conditions, responsibility and payment clauses	Core material for the recurring 'principal characteristics' question and the 2024 pay-if-paid question.
5	9	Concerns over subcontractors	No direct standalone question yet, but useful for critical discussion and expanding long answers.

2. Detailed Year-wise Question Mapping

Question wording has been lightly standardized only for readability. 'Primary' gives the best starting slide(s); 'Support' gives additional slides. 'QB p.' is the page number in the uploaded question-bank PDF.

Examinations 2016-2018

Year	Original	Marks	QB p.	Question / task	Match	Primary	Support	Coverage assessment
2016	Sec B 6(c)	15	2	Define contractor and subcontractor. When and why are contractors required to appoint a subcontractor? Explain.	Exact	3-4, 8	5-6	Slides 3-4 define the general contractor and subcontractor. Slide 8 gives the reasons for subcontracting, while Slides 5-6 add the responsibility and supervision framework.
2017	Sec B 8(d)	12	6	Describe the principal characteristics of typical subcontracting in the construction field.	Direct	5-6	4, 7	Slides 5-6 provide the main contractual characteristics: common terms, main-contractor responsibility, approval, payment and supervision. Slide 7 adds payment-condition clauses.
2018	Sec A 1(a)	10	7	Write down the principal characteristics of typical subcontracting in the construction field.	Direct	5-6	4, 7	The answer is assembled mainly from Slides 5-6, supported by the definition on Slide 4 and payment terms on Slide 7.
2018	Sec A 3(a)	10	7	What is attendance in subcontracting? State the principal characteristics of typical subcontracting in the construction field.	Direct	15, 5-6	4	Slide 15 directly defines attendance, its service examples and general/special forms. Slides 5-6 provide the characteristics portion.

Examinations 2019-2021

Year	Original	Marks	QB p.	Question / task	Match	Primary	Support	Coverage assessment
2019	Sec B 6(b)	12	10	Why are subcontractors needed in the construction industry? Write short notes on domestic, nominated and named subcontractors.	Exact	8, 10-14	4	Slide 8 gives the reasons, Slide 10 introduces the three types, and Slides 11-14 explain each type and its appointment/payment arrangement.
2020	Sec B 5(b)	10	13	Write short notes on domestic subcontractors, nominated subcontractors and named subcontractors.	Exact	10-14	5	Slides 10-14 are a direct topic-by-topic match. Slide 5 provides useful general responsibility and payment context.
2021	Sec B 6(c)	10	16	What is attendance in subcontracting? State the principal characteristics of typical subcontracting in the construction field.	Direct	15, 5-6	4	Slide 15 answers attendance; Slides 5-6 supply the standard subcontracting characteristics.
2021	Sec B 7(a)	10	16	Why are subcontractors needed in the construction industry? Write short notes on domestic, nominated and named subcontractors.	Exact	8, 10-14	4	The lecture follows exactly this structure: reason for subcontracting on Slide 8, then the three types on Slides 10-14.

Examinations 2022-2024

Year	Original	Marks	QB p.	Question / task	Match	Primary	Support	Coverage assessment
2022	Sec B 6(a)	10	19	Define attendance in subcontracting. State the principal characteristics of typical subcontracting in the construction field.	Direct	15, 5-6	4	Slide 15 directly covers attendance; Slides 5-6 provide the features of the subcontract relationship.
2023	Sec B 7(b)	10	21	What is attendance in subcontracting? State the principal characteristics of typical subcontracting in the construction field.	Direct	15, 5-6	4	This repeats the 2018/2021/2022 pattern. Use Slide 15 for attendance and Slides 5-6 for the characteristics.
2023	Sec B 8(b)	9	22	Write short notes on domestic subcontractors, nominated subcontractors and named subcontractors.	Exact	10-14	5	Slides 10-14 directly cover the classification and the distinguishing features of all three types.
2024	Sec B 6(a)	7	24	Describe the pay-if-paid clause and explain why courts generally regard the clause with disfavor.	Partial	7	-	Slide 7 identifies pay-if-paid as a dangerous clause for subcontractors, but it does not explain the legal reasoning or court treatment. Class notes or another legal source are required for the second half.
2024	Sec B 6(b)	13	24	Define attendance. Identify and explain the different types of subcontractors and the specific roles they play in the overall construction process.	Exact	15, 10-14	4-6	Slide 15 defines attendance; Slides 10-14 explain domestic, nominated and named subcontractors. Slides 4-6 add their relationship to the main contractor and project supervision.

3. Repeated-question Analysis

Several categories overlap: for example, the 2024 question contains both attendance and subcontractor types. Counts below show how often each topic appears, not mutually exclusive totals.

Repeated theme	Frequency	Years	Best slides	Priority
Typical subcontracting characteristics	6	2017, 2018 (two questions), 2021, 2022, 2023	Slides 5-6; support 4 and 7	Very high
Domestic, nominated and named subcontractors	5	2019, 2020, 2021, 2023, 2024	Slides 10-14	Very high
Attendance	5	2018, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024	Slide 15	Very high
Why appoint/use subcontractors	3	2016, 2019, 2021	Slide 8; support 3-4	High
Contractor/subcontractor definitions	1 major	2016	Slides 3-4	Medium
Pay-if-paid clause and court disfavor	1	2024	Slide 7 only partly	Emerging / gap

Year-wise coverage

Year	Links	Marks	Questions	Classification
2016	1	15	6(c)	Exact
2017	1	12	8(d)	Direct
2018	2	20	1(a), 3(a)	Direct
2019	1	12	6(b)	Exact
2020	1	10	5(b)	Exact
2021	2	20	6(c), 7(a)	Direct; Exact
2022	1	10	6(a)	Direct
2023	2	19	7(b), 8(b)	Direct; Exact
2024	2	20	6(a), 6(b)	Exact; Partial

Trend

From 2017 through 2023, examiners repeatedly recycled two stable formats: (1) attendance plus principal characteristics, and (2) domestic/nominated/named subcontractors. In 2024, the question style became more applied by adding court treatment of pay-if-paid and asking the roles of subcontractor types in the full construction process.

4. Slide-to-Question Reverse Index

Slides	Content	Mapped questions	Priority
1-2	Title and lecture outline	No standalone exam question	Low
3	General contractor: definition and day-to-day role	2016 Q6(c)	High
4	Subcontractor: definition and typical work packages	2016 Q6(c); supports characteristics questions	High
5-6	Subcontract relationship, responsibility, approval, payment and supervision	2017 Q8(d); 2018 Q1(a), Q3(a); 2021 Q6(c); 2022 Q6(a); 2023 Q7(b); supports 2024 Q6(b)	Very high
7	Pay-when-paid and pay-if-paid clauses	2024 Q6(a); supports characteristics questions	High / incomplete
8	Why use subcontractors	2016 Q6(c); 2019 Q6(b); 2021 Q7(a)	High
9	Concerns: skill, quality, safety, coordination and supervision	No direct standalone question; useful expansion	Medium
10	Types overview: domestic, nominated, named	2019 Q6(b); 2020 Q5(b); 2021 Q7(a); 2023 Q8(b); 2024 Q6(b)	Very high
11	Domestic subcontractor	Same five classification questions	Very high
12	Nominated subcontractor	Same five classification questions	Very high
13-14	Named subcontractor and tender/provisional-sum process	Same five classification questions	Very high
15	Attendance: definition, examples, general and special attendance	2018 Q3(a); 2021 Q6(c); 2022 Q6(a); 2023 Q7(b); 2024 Q6(b)	Very high
16	Thank-you slide	No question	None

5. Exam Answer Construction Guide

The following checklists are reorganized only from the uploaded lecture. They are intended to help combine the correct slides under recurring exam wording.

A. Principal characteristics of typical subcontracting (Slides 5-7)

1.	The subcontractor enters under terms and conditions connected with the main contract.
2.	The main contractor remains fully responsible for the subcontracted work.
3.	Nominated subcontractors require Architect/Engineer approval.
4.	Payment is normally made by the main contractor; direct payment applies only when the contract permits it.
5.	Architect/Engineer supervision is equivalent to the supervision of work performed by the main contractor.
6.	A non-compliant nominated subcontractor should not be employed.
7.	If the whole work is subcontracted, the main contractor effectively performs a project-management role.
8.	Payment clauses include pay-when-paid and pay-if-paid; the lecture flags pay-if-paid as dangerous for the subcontractor.

B. Domestic, nominated and named subcontractors (Slides 10-14)

1.	Domestic: selected, appointed, paid, managed and supervised by the main contractor; direct contractual relationship is with the main contractor.
2.	Nominated: selected by the client; the client negotiates the price and instructs the main contractor to appoint; price enters the main contract as a prime cost sum plus overhead, profit and attendance.
3.	Named: selected for a package from a client-provided acceptable list; tender documents contain a provisional sum and allowances for markup, attendance and programme; later the main contractor seeks package tenders and replaces the provisional sum with the successful figure.

C. Attendance (Slide 15)

1.	Attendance is the main contractor's markup for specific services supplied to individual subcontractors.
2.	Examples include material handling, scaffolding and rubbish clearance.
3.	General attendance covers site-wide items available to all subcontractors.
4.	Special attendance covers items specific to a particular contractor or subcontractor.

6. Exam-focused Study Plan & Limitations

Recommended revision order for the term final:

Order	Slides	Action
Step 1	Slide 15 + Slides 5-6	Prepare the recurring 10-mark answer on attendance and typical subcontracting characteristics.
Step 2	Slides 10-14	Memorize a comparison of domestic, nominated and named subcontractors: who selects, who appoints, contractual relationship, payment and tender treatment.
Step 3	Slides 3-4 + 8	Learn the contractor/subcontractor definitions and the reasons for subcontracting, including complexity and risk transfer.
Step 4	Slide 7	Distinguish pay-when-paid from pay-if-paid exactly as the lecture states. Flag the 2024 legal explanation as requiring another source.
Step 5	Slide 9	Use the listed concerns to strengthen analytical answers: competency, workmanship, safety, communication, coordination and supervision.

Important limitations and source gaps

Question / gap	What the uploaded lecture supports
2024 Q6(a): why courts regard pay-if-paid with disfavor	Slide 7 only states that pay-if-paid is dangerous for the subcontractor. It does not present court reasoning, legal doctrine or case examples.
Detailed legal distinction between pay-when-paid and pay-if-paid	The lecture gives only short labels: pay-when-paid protects main-contractor cash flow, while pay-if-paid is dangerous for the subcontractor.
A fully developed critical discussion of subcontractor disadvantages	Slide 9 lists the concerns but does not provide case studies or mitigation methods.
Specialist subcontractors beyond the three named categories	The deck classifies domestic, nominated and named subcontractors only. Do not add categories unless the instructor supplied them elsewhere.

Bottom line

This lecture is one of the safest high-yield sections in the question bank: its core questions recur every year. Prioritize Slide 15, Slides 5-6 and Slides 10-14 first; together they cover the most repeated 9-13 mark formats.